

OE3C Planning Meeting 10

Date: 05 Mar 2026

Location: CRN527/Online

Time: 11:03 AM – 12:02 PM

Attendees: Lyllian Corbin, Alex Wilder, Kiyoko Gotanda, Reem Mahamoud, Sarah Hein, Matthew Summerville, Madelaine Legault, Cassia Hamilton, Wylan Clitheroe, Katherine Yagi, Miriam Richards, Paige Au

Chair: Alex Wilder

Minutes by: Lyllian Corbin

[Recap: OE3C Standing Meeting time Thursday, March 05 | Meeting | Microsoft Teams](#)

Alex began the meeting at 11:03 AM.

Call to Order and Approval of Minutes

- Minutes approved
 - o Lyllly will update 19-Feb meeting minutes with Madelaine's notes appended

Fundraising Updates

- Alex needs help with sending out sponsor requests, please contact ASAP
 - o Harry and Paige offered to help with sponsors
- Alex received an offer for two \$50 Amazon gift cards
 - o These gift cards could be used for prizes
- The FMS Dean agreed to fund us \$3000
 - o KG is working on VPR request for funds
- Local businesses can be contacted eventually for donations that we can use to cover transportation costs, etc.

Registration Update

- Update from Reem
 - o Registration website is up, two people have registered as of today
 - The committee has codes for registration that need to be used ASAP

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- Can be found under General section in Teams
 - Code for registration and banquet: **WILDIDEAS2026**
- One t-shirt sale so far
- People have been organised by their dietary restrictions and banquet ticket orders
- Discussion on including CCOVI event on registration page
 - Madelaine set up a tour and tasting event for Apr 30th
 - Cap on the event is 25 people
 - Deadline to sign up is Apr 16th
 - Reem will include the event on the registration page
 - We agreed to charge \$10 per person to help absorb costs
 - Miriam recommended that all registration links should be on one page so its easier to find
 - We can include details that there is a limited cap for the event
 - Kiyoko asked about including a waitlist
 - Reem agreed to having a waitlist on a separate Google doc
 - Alex suggested that the waitlist could be put on a different link on the registration page
 - People can sign up on the waitlist if the event cap is reached
- Update from Lauren
 - Working through university contact list to send announcements that registration is open (sent 540 emails so far!)
 - Lauren asked for everyone to take 5 universities to help find contact information for undergraduate and graduate departments
 - Looking at EEB for Toronto
 - Alex has emails from Windsor and will share them with Lauren
 - When looking for contact info, Lauren suggested to type in the university and faculty then look for contact list
 - E.g., "UofT bio contact list"
 - **University contact list:** [University contact list .xlsx](#)

Social Media Update with Matt

- Socials have been good
 - Alex will help with posting stories
- Matt has lined up posts for the next couple of weeks
 - Will start to post daily
 - Will be posting about keynote speakers
 - Working on Twitter posts
- Miriam asked about OE3C on Bluesky

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- The OE3C handle is: @oe3c.ca
 - Matt explained that the updated handle has integrated the OE3C website with the Bluesky handle
 - Login is the same password
- Original handle (oe3c_official.bsky.social) is now inactive
 - Not rerouting to the new user handle

Catering Update with Lyllian

- Break down of coffee break orders
 - Amount for one order would be ~\$1632
 - Total cost for 5 breaks = \$8160
 - Estimated cost for 200 guests = \$40.80 per person
 - We are okay with these costs for now
- Alex explained the cost will increase because we are adding more coffee breaks to the schedule
 - No objections

Banquet Update with Cassia

- Keeping sangria in the order will put us over the budgeted \$90 per person
 - We agreed to remove the sangria option

Workshops and Outings

- Update from Wylan
 - Working on hikes and scavenger hunt
 - Currently tweaking the length of the hikes
 - Scavenger hunt will be figured out closer to the conference
 - Alex has a contact that can help code an app, so people can scan QR codes during the scavenger hunt
 - Might cost \$20, Alex is willing to pay
 - Please contact Alex if you have further ideas for this
- Update from Nick (Madelaine speaking for him)
 - Met with Rasa and Sowmya to discuss the computer science workshop
 - Goal is to have something that people can do after the workshop
 - Simulation will be on Ecology and Evolution
 - There will be an intro to the software and variables that can change
 - Code will be 90% done with gaps that people have to fill in

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- There will be a competition to see who can create the most optimised simulation of the model
 - Will have more updates on the schedule after their predoctoral exam
 - Will also contact Kiyoko to discuss art gallery ideas
 - Abstracts
 - Form will be modified soon
 - Need feedback on form by Monday, Mar 8th
 - Contact by Mar 8th to be on abstract judging committee
- Update from Madelaine
 - Working with Alex to contact Cindy for the Indigenous Ecology workshop
 - Working on photo contest on PollUnit
 - Madelaine asked if the contest should be open for April or now (1-month vs 2-month subscription). The poll needs to last until Sunday, May 3rd
 - Kiyoko voted to open the contest now because we can afford a 2-month subscription and it will last until May 3rd
 - PollUnit business subscription can have up to 5 admins
 - Kiyoko will work on this soon
 - Madelaine had an idea to have the OE3C Brock Badger holding a camera for the logo on the poll
 - Lauren will work on this
 - CCOVI tour and tasting event
 - Madelaine set up a tour and tasting event with Taylor
 - Apr 30th from 3:00 pm to 4:30 pm
 - Cost = \$15-20 per person (~\$500)
 - Alex agreed to request that CCOVI donate a portion of wines
 - Might have to contact Debbie about this
 - Madelaine asked Taylor to select wines that best represent Niagara and Brock
- Update from Alex
 - Niagara Falls outing
 - Alex is waiting to hear back from salesperson for a discount on the NF passes
 - Also contacted Niagara Transit and is waiting to hear their decision on providing 2 city buses that drive from Brock to NF
 - We could also rent a school bus for this
 - Madelaine is willing to help with any logistics if needed
 - Jayne and Allsion offered to do workshops
 - Workshops would be on: Knowledge Mobilisation and Podcasting
 - They will get back to us with more detail on their availability

Schedule Update with Alex

- We agreed that we don't need the Goodman Atrium anymore, so Kiyoko will cancel that booking
- Kiyoko confirmed they requested Thistle rooms: TH255–TH259
 - o Plaza 4th floor is booked for poster sessions
- Alex revised the schedule from Sarah
 - o Bolded sections can be adjusted if there aren't enough people registered for those sections
 - o Sections with asterisks will have refreshments
 - o Sarah suggested to align the lunch times slots so its visually clear the times are the same
 - o Matt will post the updated schedule on socials
 - Alex will send the pdf and text files to Matt so he can split the schedule into 2 slides
 - Katherine suggested having the same column headers for both slides on the social post

Merch Update

- Paige will be working with Katherine to organise notebooks
 - o Meeting with Lauren and Sarah to discuss ideas

General Discussion

- Harry confirmed that Melanie from McGill will be the Ethology keynote
- Catering discussion
 - o Coffee breaks in between presentations
 - Sarah raised a concern about reducing food waste (what if we have food leftover after the breaks?)
 - Alex and Lyly will talk to Nichole and Serge (from Brock Dining)
 - o We can ask to put the leftovers in a box and donate somewhere (e.g., Happy Rolph's Animal Farm)
 - o We will also have take-out boxes available for the lunches, so people can also use take-out boxes to grab more refreshments
 - Breaks and refreshes (brief snacks) are different orders
 - o There will be 3 lunch orders (1 lunch per day for Thurs, Fri, and Sat)
 - Sign-up for these lunches is on the registration page

Meeting adjourned at 12:02 PM.